Aaron Stagoff-Belfort

University of Chicago
Department of Sociology
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Education

University of Chicago 2023–present
Ph.D. in Sociology; M.A. in Sociology
Dissertation: "Governing Against the City: Police Unions and Urban Governance"
Committee: Robert Vargas (chair), Geoffrey Wodtke, Julian Go, Gerard Torrats-Espinosa (Columbia)

Wesleyan University 2018
B.A., College of Social Studies

Research Interests

Policing, Urban Sociology, Race & Ethnicity, Inequality, Quantitative Methodology

Employment & Research Experience

Graduate Research Scholar, Justice Policy Lab, Watson Institute, Brown University 2026–present

Graduate Student Research Scholar, Policing Project, NYU School of Law 2025–present

Research Assistant, UChicago Justice Project 2023–2026

Program Associate, Vera Institute of Justice 2019–2023

Research Assistant, *New York Times* 2017–2018

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Aaron Stagoff-Belfort, Jon Ben-Menachem,* and Brenden Beck. 2025. "Can Speed Cameras Make Streets Safer? Quasi-Experimental Evidence From New York City." *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences.*

Press: Vital City, Streetsblog NYC. Top 5% of all research outputs scored by Altmetric; 99th percentile Attention Score relative to outputs of the same age.

Leah G. Pope, **Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, et al. 2023. "Competing Concerns in Efforts to Reduce Criminal Legal System Entanglement among People with Serious Mental Illnesses: Findings from a Multi-City Study on Misdemeanor Arrests." *Administration and Policy in Mental Health and Mental Health Services Research* 50(5–6).

Michael T. Compton, Leah G. Pope, Amanda Warnock, Nili Gesser, **Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, et al. 2023. "Contexts Shaping Misdemeanor System Interventions with People Affected by Mental Illnesses: Findings from a Multi-City System Mapping Exercise." *Health and Justice* 11.

Michael T. Compton, Adria Zern, Leah G. Pope, Nili Gesser, **Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, et al. 2022. "Misdemeanor Charges Among Individuals with Serious Mental Illnesses: A Statewide Analysis of More Than Two Million Arrests." *Psychiatric Services.*

*Denotes graduate student coauthor.

Book Chapters

Aaron Stagoff-Belfort and Jason Tan de Bibiana. 2024. "Being in the Wrong Place: Criminal Trespass and Criminal Legal System Entanglement." In *Entangled: How People with Serious Mental Illnesses Get and Stay Caught up in Misdemeanor Systems*, edited by Leah G. Pope, Amy C. Watson, Jennifer D. Wood, and Michael T. Compton. Washington, DC: APA Publishing.

Under Review

Aaron Stagoff-Belfort, Ángela Zorro Medina, David Hackett, and Robert Vargas. "The Diffusion of Policing Alternatives in U.S. Cities After the George Floyd Protests." *Conditionally accepted, American Sociological Review.*

Work in Progress

Aaron Stagoff-Belfort and Devin Green. "Black Power, Blue Power: The Civil Rights Movement and the Origin of Police Unions."

Aaron Stagoff-Belfort and Jonathan Ben-Menachem. "Promotion Practices and Police Behavior: Merit Sergeants, Supervisory Legitimacy, and Officer Misconduct."

Aaron Stagoff-Belfort, Preeti Chauhan, Richie Lin, and Therese L. Todd. "Does Crisis Intervention Training Change How Police Handle Mental Health Calls? Evidence from Seattle's 40-hour Crisis Intervention Team (CIT) Training."

Aaron Stagoff-Belfort and David Hackett. "When Policing Technology is Discontinued: Response Times and Crime After Chicago's ShotSpotter Decommission."

Aaron Stagoff-Belfort, Roman Rivera, and Matthew Ross. Seattle Deterrence Study (title forthcoming).

Book Reviews

Aaron Stagoff-Belfort. 2026. Review of *Blue Power: How Police Organized to Protect and Serve Themselves*, by Stuart Schrader. *Sociological Forum*. https://doi.org/10.1111/socf.70073

Other Publications

Jason Tan de Bibiana, Kerry Mulligan, **Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, and Daniela Gilbert. 2023. "Coordinating Safety: Building and Sustaining Offices of Violence Prevention and Neighborhood Safety." Vera Institute of Justice.

Aaron Stagoff-Belfort, Dan Bodah, and Daniela Gilbert. 2022. "The Social Costs of Policing." Vera Institute of Justice.

Jackson Beck, **Aaron Stagoff-Belfort**, and Jason Tan de Bibiana. 2022. "Civilian Crisis Response: A Toolkit for Equitable Alternatives to Policing." Vera Institute of Justice.

Aaron Stagoff-Belfort and Mary Fleck. 2021. "Reducing Policing's Footprint? Racial Disparities and Arrest Trends After Misdemeanor Decriminalization and Legalization in Denver and Philadelphia." Vera Institute of Justice.

Grants & Fellowships

Stigler Center PhD Dissertation Award (Bradley Fellow), University of Chicago Booth School of Business ($5,000) 2026

Crime, Law, and Deviance Section Award, American Sociological Association ($500) 2026

Charles R. Henderson Research Fund Grant, University of Chicago ($2,000) 2026

Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation ($159,000) 2025

Charles R. Henderson Research Fund Grant, University of Chicago ($3,500) 2025

Research Grant, Midwest Sociological Society ($2,500) 2025

Urban Doctoral Fellowship, Mansueto Institute for Urban Innovation, University of Chicago ($1,000) 2024

Honors & Awards

Wayne C. Booth Graduate Student Prize for Excellence in Teaching, University of Chicago 2026

1st Place, Graduate Student Paper Competition, Midwest Sociological Society 2025

Conference Presentations

2026: Conference on Empirical Legal Studies (CELS), Northwestern Pritzker School of Law; Harvard Urban Data Lab; Law & Society Association Annual Meeting; Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics Annual Meeting; American Sociological Association Annual Meeting; Northwestern Urban Workshop; Midwest Sociological Society Annual Meeting; New School Carceral Political Economy Conference; UChicago Stone Center Inequality Working Group

2025: Arnold Ventures and George Mason University: Justice Reimagined; American Sociological Association Annual Meeting; Society for the Study of Social Problems Annual Meeting; American Society of Criminology Annual Meeting; UChicago Spring Institute; UChicago Race & Racial Ideologies Working Group

2024: American Society of Criminology Annual Meeting; UChicago Critical Social Science Initiative

2023: American Society of Criminology Annual Meeting

2022: American Society of Criminology Annual Meeting; Motion for Justice National Convening, Vera Institute of Justice

2021: Temple Law Review and Center for Public Health Law Research Symposium; Academy of Criminal Justice Sciences Annual Meeting

Teaching Experience

University of Chicago

Teaching Assistant, *Regression and Generalized Linear Models* (Prof. Geoffrey Wodtke) 2026

Teaching Assistant, *Cities, Space, Power: Intro to Urban Social Science* (Prof. Neil Brenner) 2026

Teaching Assistant, *Statistical Methods of Research II* (Prof. Geoffrey Wodtke) 2025

Teaching Assistant, *Introduction to Applied Statistics and Data Science* (Prof. Marshall Jean) 2025

The Petey Greene Program

Prison Education Tutor 2020–2023

Professional Service

Assistant Editor, *American Journal of Sociology* 2025–present

Journal Referee: *Police Quarterly*, *Annals of Internal Medicine*

Affiliations

American Sociological Association (ASA); American Society of Criminology (ASC); Law & Society Association (LSA)

References

Robert Vargas, University of Chicago, robvargas@uchicago.edu
Julian Go, University of Chicago, jgo34@uchicago.edu
Geoffrey Wodtke, University of Chicago, gwodtke@uchicago.edu
Gerard Torrats-Espinosa, Columbia University, gerard.torrats@columbia.edu
Brenden Beck, Rutgers University, brenden.beck@rutgers.edu